

AI TOOLS THAT WORK

# Move Checklist

One real official page, turned into a checklist, then checked line by line.

Tested October 4, 2026

# Why this guide

Say you are moving next month and want your mail to follow. The official page on forwarding mail is long and full of exceptions.

I pasted the key parts into an AI chat and asked questions, answering only from that text. Then I asked for a checklist. Then I checked both against the page.

The page and the AI answers are real. The mover is made up.

## How I tested

I used a free public chat demo, with no account and no payment: the Qwen3 demo on Hugging Face ([huggingface.co/spaces/Qwen/Qwen3-Demo](https://huggingface.co/spaces/Qwen/Qwen3-Demo)), model shown as Qwen3-235B-A22B.

I read the page on October 4, 2026 at 10:28 AM Saudi time and ran the chats at about 10:34 AM. I used two chats: one for questions, one for the checklist. One run each, so another run can answer differently.

**My first try failed.** I put the checklist request and the questions in one prompt. The demo kept thinking for over four minutes and the page stopped updating. I started over and split it in two. Lesson: ask for one kind of thing at a time.

I trimmed the page for the prompt. I wrote "\$1.25" as "1.25 dollars" because the demo garbles dollar signs, and I removed trademark marks and links. The full page is linked at the end.

## PART 1

# Questions from the page

The excerpt, as pasted (USPS, read October 4, 2026):

Plan ahead. Although mail forwarding may begin within 3 business days of your submitted request, it's best to allow up to 2 weeks. Mail will be forwarded to your new address as it comes, piece by piece.

### What Mail Is Forwarded

- First-Class mail and periodicals (newsletters and magazines) are forwarded for free.
- Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, and USPS Ground Advantage items are forwarded for free.

- Media Mail items are forwarded, but you must pay the cost for shipping from your local Post Office location to your new address.

- USPS Marketing Mail is not forwarded.

Your change of address order only changes your mailing address with the Post Office. You must still update government agencies (like for your benefits, driver's license, and voter registration) and companies (like banks, insurance, online stores, etc.).

You must submit your change of address request in person at a Post Office location if you're moving outside the United States, you're submitting a change of request for someone else, or you're unable to verify your identity online.

#### How to Change Your Address Online

1. Choose an option for either an "Individual," "Family" (where everyone has the same last name), or "Business" move, and complete the form.
2. Verify your identity: opt in online to receive a verification code or link on your mobile phone.
3. Pay the 1.25 dollar identity verification fee. The billing address on your credit card must match either your old or new address.
4. If your online identity verification succeeds, USPS will email you a confirmation code. Use this code if you need to modify or cancel your request.

Source: [usps.com/manage/forward.htm](https://usps.com/manage/forward.htm)

# What the AI wrote

## ANSWERS, 6.6 SECONDS

The request must be made in person when moving outside the U.S., submitting for someone else, or if unable to verify identity online.

No, USPS Marketing Mail is not forwarded.

The mover must update government agencies (e.g., benefits, driver's license, voter registration) and companies (e.g., banks, insurance, online stores).

Not in the text.

### What it got right

- All four answers match the text.
- Question 4 was the trap: the excerpt gives no counter fee. It said "Not in the text", and did not invent one.
- It listed the three in-person cases correctly.

## What needed fixing

- The answers are short and drop details. For example, the page says the 1.25 dollar fee is for online identity checks only. Read the page before you pay.
- Question 3: the page says your change only updates the Post Office, so everything else is still yours to update. It said so, in fewer words.

## PART 2

# The checklist

In a separate chat, with the same text, I asked for a numbered checklist in order.

## ANSWER, 20.5 SECONDS

Allow up to 2 weeks for mail forwarding by submitting your request early, even though it may begin within 3 business days.

Update your mailing address separately with government agencies (e.g., benefits, driver's license, voter registration) and companies (e.g., banks, insurance, online stores).

Submit your change of address request in person at a Post Office if moving outside the U.S., submitting for someone else, or unable to verify your identity online.

Choose an "Individual," "Family," or "Business" option online and complete the form.

Verify your identity by opting to receive a code or link via mobile phone.

Pay the \$1.25 identity verification fee using a credit card with a billing address matching your old or new address.

Receive a confirmation code via email after successful verification for future modifications or cancellations.

### **What it got right**

- Every fact is in the page: the 2-week advice, the three in-person cases, the three online steps, the fee, the confirmation code.
- No invented steps and no outside facts.

## What needed fixing

- The order is off. It puts "update government agencies and companies" second, though that is separate work that can happen any time. And it lists the in-person cases as a step, but they are conditions: you go in person only if one applies.
- "Allow up to 2 weeks" is advice, not a step. The page says forwarding may start within 3 business days, but allow up to 2 weeks.
- It left out which mail is forwarded for free and that Marketing Mail is not. I did not ask, but a mover might want it.
- The list numbers got lost when I saved the page text. The chat itself may show them.

**Lesson:** ask for a checklist in two parts: things to do, and conditions that might apply.

# What I took from this

Every fact was right. The weak spot was structure: a checklist that mixed steps, advice and conditions.

1. Paste text from the real page.
2. Ask one question the page cannot answer.
3. Watch for conditions listed as steps.
4. Check what is missing.
5. Check fees and dates on the live page before you act.

# The prompts

Where the page goes, it says [PASTE THE TEXT HERE]. Put your own text there.

## PROMPT 1: QUESTIONS

Below is an excerpt from a US Postal Service web page. Answer ONLY from the text. If the text does not say, write "Not in the text". Do not add outside facts. Plain text only, no tables. Answer each question in one or two lines.

TEXT:

[PASTE THE TEXT HERE: the excerpt shown in the example above]

QUESTIONS:

1. When must the request be made in person?
2. Is Marketing Mail forwarded?
3. What else must the mover update besides the Post Office?
4. What does it cost to change your address at the Post Office counter?

**PROMPT 2: CHECKLIST**

Below is an excerpt from a US Postal Service web page. Using ONLY the text, write a numbered checklist of what a mover should do, in order. Do not add outside facts. Plain text only, no tables.

TEXT:

[PASTE THE TEXT HERE: the excerpt shown in the example above]

# Limits and sources

- One public demo model, one day, one run per prompt. Another run or tool can answer differently, including wrongly.
- The excerpt is trimmed and slightly edited, as explained above.
- This is not postal or legal advice. Fees and rules change, so check the page.

## SOURCES

USPS, Standard Forward Mail, read October 4, 2026:  
[usps.com/manage/forward.htm](https://usps.com/manage/forward.htm)

Qwen3 demo:

[huggingface.co/spaces/Qwen/Qwen3-Demo](https://huggingface.co/spaces/Qwen/Qwen3-Demo)

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